

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 816

By Stevens

A RESOLUTION to recognize Phil Rogers on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should specially recognize those outstanding professionals who devoted their careers to providing the highest-quality education and learning environments for Tennessee's students; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable individual is Phil Rogers, who, having distinguished himself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity throughout his career, took his well-deserved retirement as the principal of South Gibson High School in June 2025; and

WHEREAS, a native of West Tennessee, Phil Rogers graduated from Riverside High School before attending Freed Hardeman University, where he earned a degree in education; he received his master's degree from the University of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Rogers began his exemplary career in the classroom as a teacher, coach, and athletic director at Jackson Christian School; he taught a number of different grade levels and courses, including physical education, health, science, and driver's education in addition to coaching baseball, football, and basketball; and

WHEREAS, his next teaching post took him to University School of Jackson, where he got his first experience in administration, serving as the middle school dean of students, athletic director, and eventually middle school director; he obtained his administration and supervision license in 1987; and

WHEREAS, while working at University School of Jackson, Mr. Rogers was hit head-on by a drunk driver on his way back from a football game, with the resulting injuries and physical limitations shaping his career choices moving forward; and

WHEREAS, two years after the accident, he accepted a position with Jackson Central Merry High School, where he worked as a science teacher and helped with administrative roles for athletics before being named assistant principal and athletic director for the school in 1994; and

WHEREAS, in 2007, Phil Rogers was offered the position of principal at Gibson County High School, where he remained for a year before he was named the principal of the brand new South Gibson High School in January 2009; and

WHEREAS, Principal Phil Rogers quickly established a record of excellence at South Gibson and he continued to demonstrate the utmost professionalism during his sixteen years leading the school; and

WHEREAS, Principal Rogers truly served as an inspiration to the faculty and staff at South Gibson High School, and his friendship and counsel have always been highly valued by those who are fortunate to know him; and

WHEREAS, his numerous professional achievements aside, Mr. Rogers is most grateful for the love and support he shares with his family and looks forward to spending more time with them, attending University of Memphis football games, and going fishing; and

WHEREAS, Phil Rogers is an extremely talented and compassionate administrator who worked assiduously throughout his career in education to motivate his students, teachers, and staff to reach their full potential as scholars, professionals, and citizens; and

WHEREAS, Phil Rogers epitomizes the dedicated principal who is wholly committed to the highest ideals of public service and quality education for all, and he should be specially recognized on the occasion of his retirement; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Phil Rogers upon his exceptional service to the students and schools of Tennessee, salute his professional expertise

and personal excellence, and wish him much continued success and happiness during his retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.